

ASIA

Gyokuro tea is the highest quality of shaded green tea. "Gyokuro" translates to "jade dew," indicating the color of the pale green infusion.



Hokkaido

Sapporo

PACIFIC OCEAN

THE FIRST TEA OF THE NEW SEASON'S HARVEST IS CALLED SHINCHA

KYOTO PREFECTURE

Kyoto is an ancient tea-growing area, and the town of Uji is a key area for the production of Gyokuro and Matcha (both shaded for two weeks before harvest). Other areas in Central Honshu, Nara, and Mie produce Sencha, Bancha, and Kabusicha.

SHIZUOKA PREFECTURE

Located on the Pacific side of the main island of Honshu, Shizuoka is responsible for half of Japan's tea output and produces mostly Sencha tea. The region experiences wet, cool weather, which is ideal for var. *sinensis*.

ARACHA

Japan is famous for its green teas, which go through a unique production process. After plucking, the tea leaves are partially processed (steamed, rolled, and dried) into a crude tea called "Aracha." This is purchased by tea brokers and then "finished" into various teas, such as Sencha, by master sorters.

Sea of Japan

Sado

JAPAN

Sendai

Tōkyō

Yokohama

Nagoya

SHIZUOKA

KYŌTO

Osaka

Okayama

Hiroshima

Shikoku

Kōchi

KEY



NOTABLE TEA-PRODUCING REGIONS



AREA OF PRODUCTION

KAGOSHIMA PREFECTURE

Located on Kyushu, the southernmost island of Japan, Kagoshima has 15 tea-growing regions and is famous for a wide selection of styles of green tea—Gyokuro, Sencha, Bancha, and Kamairicha. Other producing areas of Kyushu are Saga, Fukuoka, and Miyazaki.

KAGOSHIMA

Kumamoto

Kyushu

Fukuoka

Nagasaki

East China Sea